
Informed Consent Form

Study Title: A Phase 2b, Randomized, Double-Blind, Placebo-Controlled, Dose-Ranging Study to Evaluate the Efficacy and Safety of Subcutaneous Veltrazane in Adults with Moderate-to-Severe Atopic Dermatitis

Protocol Number: VTZ-2201 | **Consent Version:** 3.0 | **Date:** 26 May 2026

Sponsor: Meridian Biopharma, Inc. | **Site:** Meridian Clinical Research Center, Boston, MA

Principal Investigator: Dr. Elena Vasquez, MD, PhD

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1. Key Information

This section highlights the most important things you should know before deciding. More detail follows in the rest of this form.

- You are being asked to join a **research study** of an experimental injectable medicine called **Veltrazane** for moderate-to-severe atopic dermatitis (eczema). Veltrazane is not approved by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration (FDA).
- Taking part is **completely voluntary**. You may say no, or stop at any time, without penalty and without losing any benefits or medical care you would otherwise receive.
- The study lasts about **24 weeks (about 6 months)** and involves **nine (9) clinic visits and one telephone check-in**.
- You will be assigned by chance to Veltrazane every 2 weeks, Veltrazane every 4 weeks, or **placebo** (an injection with no medicine). You have a 2 in 3 chance of receiving Veltrazane. Neither you nor the study doctor will know your assignment.
- The most common side effects seen so far are **injection-site reactions, eye inflammation (conjunctivitis), and headache**. A **severe allergic reaction** is possible; you will be observed in the clinic after your injections.
- The main alternative to joining is continuing standard care with your own doctor. Joining may or may not improve your eczema.

2. Why is this study being done?

This study involves research. Its purpose is to find out whether Veltrazane, an experimental antibody medicine that blocks a signal involved in itching and skin inflammation (interleukin-31), is safe and effective for adults with moderate-to-severe atopic dermatitis, and which of two dosing schedules works better. About 240 people at approximately 45 research sites will take part.

Veltrazane is experimental: it has not been approved by the FDA, and receiving it in this study is an experimental procedure.

3. How long will I be in the study, and what will happen?

Your participation will last up to about 28 weeks: a screening period of up to 4 weeks, a 16-week treatment period, and an 8-week follow-up. You will attend **nine (9) scheduled clinic visits** — screening, a baseline visit where you are randomly assigned, visits at Weeks 2, 4, 8, 12, and 16, and follow-up visits at Weeks 20 and 24. The study team will also call you at Week 18 to check on you.

At study visits, some or all of the following will happen:

- A physical examination and vital signs.
- Assessment of your skin (extent and severity of your eczema) and questionnaires about itch, sleep, and quality of life.
- **Injections of the study drug or placebo under the skin** of your abdomen, thigh, or upper arm, given by study staff. At your first treatment visit you will receive two injections (a loading dose). After each of your first three injection visits you will be asked to remain in the clinic for at least 60 minutes of observation, and at least 30 minutes after later injections.
- **Blood draws of about 10 mL (about 2 teaspoons) at each visit** for safety laboratory tests and research measurements.
- An electrocardiogram (ECG) at screening and at Week 16.
- Pregnancy tests, if you are a woman who can become pregnant.
- A short daily itch questionnaire on a handheld electronic diary that we will provide.

You must continue applying a moisturizer at least twice daily and must not receive live vaccines or take certain other medicines during the study; the study team will review your medications with you.

4. What are the risks and discomforts?

Veltrazane may cause side effects. In earlier studies of Veltrazane in 184 people, the following were seen:

- **Injection-site reactions** (redness, swelling, or pain where the injection was given) — about 18 out of 100 people; usually mild and gone within about two days.
- **Eye inflammation (conjunctivitis)** — about 9 out of 100 people, compared with 2 out of 100 on placebo; usually mild or moderate and treatable with eye drops. Tell the study team about any eye redness, itching, or discharge; you may be referred to an eye specialist.
- **Headache** — about 11 out of 100 people, usually mild and short-lasting.
- **A temporary rise in a type of white blood cell (eosinophils)** — about 4 out of 100 people, without symptoms; your blood tests will be checked at every visit.

Severe allergic reaction (anaphylaxis): one participant in an earlier study had a serious, non-fatal allergic reaction shortly after an injection. A severe allergic reaction can be life-threatening. This is why you will be observed in the clinic after injections. Tell staff immediately about any rash, swelling of the face or throat, dizziness, or trouble breathing.

Because Veltrazane affects the immune system, it might increase the risk of infections. Tell the study team promptly if you develop fever or signs of infection.

Study procedures also carry risks: blood draws may cause discomfort, bruising, or rarely infection; ECG electrodes may irritate the skin; and the randomization means you may receive placebo, during which your eczema may not improve or may worsen. Rescue treatment is available as described by the study doctor.

There may be side effects that are not yet known, including unknown risks to an unborn child or nursing infant. If you can become pregnant, you must use a highly effective method of birth control from screening until 16 weeks after your last dose, and you must tell the study team immediately if you become pregnant.

5. Are there benefits to taking part?

Your eczema may improve during the study, but this cannot be guaranteed, and you may receive placebo. The information learned may help people with atopic dermatitis in the future.

6. What are my alternatives?

You do not have to join this study to receive treatment. Alternatives include prescription creams and ointments (topical corticosteroids or calcineurin inhibitors), light therapy (phototherapy), and FDA-approved systemic medicines for atopic dermatitis, including approved injectable biologic medicines and oral tablets. Your doctor can discuss the risks and benefits of these options with you.

7. Will I be paid, and what does it cost?

You will receive **\$75 per completed clinic visit** (up to \$675) to compensate you for your time and travel. Payments are prorated if you withdraw early. The study drug, study-related procedures, and study visits are provided at no cost to you. You or your insurance remain responsible for your routine medical care.

8. What happens if I am injured because of the study?

If you are injured as a direct result of taking part in this study or of the study drug, **medical treatment is available, and the sponsor, Meridian Biopharma, will pay the reasonable and necessary costs of diagnosing and treating the injury** to the extent they are not covered by your health insurance or another third party. **No other compensation — for example for lost wages, disability, or discomfort — is offered.** You do not give up any legal rights by signing this form. For more information about care and compensation for a research-related injury, contact the study doctor or the sponsor's medical monitor at the numbers below.

9. How will my information be kept confidential?

Your study records will be labeled with a code number rather than your name. The list linking the code to your identity is kept securely at the study site. Records that identify you may be reviewed by the study team, the sponsor's authorized monitors and auditors, the Beacon Hill Independent Review Board, and regulatory authorities, **including the U.S. Food and Drug Administration (FDA), which may inspect study records.** Results of this study may be published, but you will not be identified. Total confidentiality cannot be absolutely guaranteed, but every reasonable safeguard is in place, and your information is handled according to applicable privacy laws.

A description of this clinical trial will be available on ClinicalTrials.gov. That website will not include information that can identify you.

10. What if new information becomes available?

You will be told in a timely manner about any new findings during the study that might affect your willingness to continue, and you may be asked to sign an updated consent form.

11. Whom can I contact?

- **Questions about the study, or a research-related injury:** Dr. Elena Vasquez, Principal Investigator — +1 (555) 310-2200. Sponsor 24-hour medical emergency line: +1 (555) 310-4471.
- **Questions about your rights as a research participant, or complaints:** Beacon Hill Independent Review Board — +1 (555) 310-9920.

12. Is participation voluntary?

Yes. Taking part in this study is entirely voluntary. You may decline to join, and you may stop at any time, for any reason, **without penalty and without losing any benefits or medical care to which you are otherwise entitled.** If you decide to withdraw, please tell the study team so they can advise a safe stopping plan and, with your permission, complete safety follow-up assessments. The study doctor or sponsor may also end your participation for safety reasons or if the study is stopped.

13. Consent and Signature

I have read this consent form (or it has been read to me). I have had the opportunity to ask questions, and my questions have been answered to my satisfaction. I understand that participation is voluntary. By signing below, I agree to take part in study VTZ-2201 and I will receive a signed and dated copy of this form.

Participant name (printed): _____

Participant signature: _____ Date: _____

Person obtaining consent (printed name, role): _____

Signature: _____ Date: _____